

Love Letter
By: Caleb Magill

I hate how I love.

Presently, my whole body is writhing with a discomfort from an anticipation. I yearn for climax. Hope is perhaps the most cruel connotator in this context; the culminations of my wisdom and logic to their fullest ends hint at the truthful, likely outcome, yet I cannot help but retain the vulnerable feeling of the possibility of a conclusion for which I hope will satiate but a fraction of my burning desires!

She's just so lovely to behold. That is to observe; to gaze upon the angel's face, so soft, and for whose features reflect a virtue envied by the most devout. God, how I'd love to hold her hand- to hold her, campus is so beautiful this time of year. Yes, she deserves to be the recipient of all my romantic idealizations, and I'd love to kiss her lips, but God, once I start, I cannot stop! I'd kiss her lips for hours, and would be perfectly content if that'd be the only thing I'd do all day. And in between occupying myself with this, I'd whisper into her ear about how much I've wanted this and for how long, that I've loved her; do love her, and will continue to love her until by last breath. That, in her arms, I am wholly satisfied and have found life's utmost purpose. I'd go further to confess that I'd like to marry her, one day, and have her babies, and that I want them to be as beautiful as us. I'd want her to know that I have only her best intentions in mind, and that I'd be her utmost protector. Because with me, she will no longer have anything to fear, and with her, I too will no longer fret anything.

And she'd be enough; indefinitely and resolutely enough, that I've no longer to worry about any perceived return to anguish. And that it'd be so very worth-it; the wait that is. That the trial and tribulation undertook by myself was not in vain, and that in the end, I was rewarded for my loyalty and persistence: to myself, and that for which I espouse. The catalyst and causation of my conviction.

I feel incoherent as thoughts of great intensity flow unbounded and uninterrupted through my mind. I am tormented by my attraction; I am unequivocally obsessed with the image of this character I've curated in my head. She's beautiful, and she's beautiful because I declare it! Virtue leads me to the most tyrannous of thoughts; I desire to possess her. I desire for an empowerment so great as to allow myself the highestmost privilege of surrendering my bitterness and spite with the world, and to allow my humility, exposed in all its nakedness, to embrace my passion with an unequivocality. For so long I've imagined myself a marauder for virtue; it's utmost defender, the one that'd be willing at once to die at its gates, and yet more recently I've instead found myself fixated on the idea of my own libertinage.

God, how I would ruin myself! I envy my future ex. Imagine how bitter, how spiteful I'd be toward the one- the first one, whom I'd espoused a passion for, and for whom, if for only but a fleeting moment, reciprocated this tender flame. And after having long since fallen victim to naïve comfort in the confines of a relationship; in having bonded my livelihood with another, I'd at once have it all ripped away from underneath me. I'd be tragic- it'd be hot. Befallen to the very trap I was so privy toward, not because I was unassuming, but because in love I could no longer restrain myself.

And the helplessness I'd have toward my desire to return to an innocence proving no more than tantalizing at the realization of the presence of a true malice in this life. And I'd be reeling at the thought of another getting a sick satisfaction at my suffering, so much so that I'd vow to myself in that moment a pledge for a permanent abstinence from love. Perhaps so deeply hurt that I'd reevaluate my own morality; newly allowing myself some plausibility in my mind for the justification of paying back my pain unto an unassuming spectator. To be newly empowered such to take hostages over my own love, and to torture them with the same cruelty which I'd endured. Perpetuating said malice until there are no more innocents left.

I wish no more to inflict pain onto myself. Help me, God, to sort it all out. Help me to understand why the intimacy and the sanctity of such a relationship is incongruent with myself and your wishes. You've told me to have patience; that I must not expect your blessings according to my convenience. You've told me to be wise; to not falsely equate my circumstance as implicit reflection of your boundless love for me. You've told me to be selfless; to uplift others in their times of need, and to be joyful for all the pleasures they experience. You've told me all so much, and yet I continue to doubt your grace because I've not achieved the end which I so earnestly seek. My triumph through tribulation has amounted to no discernible end. I simply cannot conceive of why it is my self-improvement through my suffering has no associated compensation.

For I want to be held in the arms of another, being told all which plagues me will be resolved, despite my knowing of the contrary. I want someone to feel for me just as passionately as I feel for them, fulfilling an emptiness which I cannot myself fill, despite my knowing this passion can never be matched at the capacity which I espouse. I want a partner, one who embodies an unwavering righteousness; all I could ever desire, all I could ever aspire to be. I want to be equally as enviable toward their attributes as I am grateful for their existence, a partner whose hand I can hold as we walk through the flames of Hell, together, in the face of hardship, a bond so strong nothing can break it, a partner which nullifies any such inhibition. All of these things which I selfishly crave, and yet I'm entitled to nothing!

Can you not see the extent to which I've labored for a mere chance of such a divine encounter? It is apparent to me now your judgement rests not in the measure of my morality, but instead it is I who possess the prerogative to achieve that for which I aspire. And so, whether it's an intentional trial, or for my own protection, I ask at once for its restraint to be surrendered, for if my faith has been tested insofar within this junction, I need now the freedom to demonstrate it!

Why possibly am I not deserving of your love? It's a fucking privilege that I like you, how can you not accept and submit to the sacred confines of the affection for which I intend to instill upon you? My efforts for its facilitation have received no reciprocity, in spite of it all, and I've consequently developed a rather bleak disposition. Because there exists something so naturally treacherous in carrying this hate-filled burden.

But alas; who cares what I think? Besides; It's so fucking hot; to rape the mind. But again it's the grandiose of its execution; I'm not an anarchist, much the contrary, it's the demonstration to myself of my own resolve: that I can take something so utterly painful to myself; having experienced a total anguish at its induction, and sulk within it,

and to study it, to dissect it, and to reverse-engineer it such to weaponize it. The imbecilic would call it spiteful malice, though of course this is owed to their ignorance, but why do I care? Because the whole point of this excursion was to prove to myself that I can handle it in the first place. Though I'd be lying if I hadn't admitted some desire for third-party acknowledgement; I do want others to see me- others to bear witness, and to marvel at the spectacle of such a transformative act. Because how confounding it is this realization that so much of my genuine motivation lies in spite, and that I do hold grudges, and that I vehemently seek retribution; such to be vindicated in all the ends for which I believe myself to have been wronged. They *will* atone for their sins, for I will make them.

It's all so irrational, and yet I look for the cogency between it all: this consideration and deeper exploration; this writing, all very liberating, for I've finally been exposed within the chains of my despair, tormenting me as prisoner. Though it is instead the confession, in this essay, to attest the satisfaction I get from being held captive. This infliction; of which I self-perpetuate, serving certainly a reflection of the significance for which I assign it. And though the gashes induced may scar over, and eventually heal, surely the pain of its conception will hold steadfast. And for every slicing; the devotional to my resolve, there exists a true value in the blood drawn: the scarlet spilling cries out a thousand words for instillment, and whether the silverlining be in the orgasm over its continued-sulking or the eagerness to reexperience itself, I reaffirm now my desire only for my continued automutilation. So agonizing it is the acknowledgement of her absence, so satisfying it is the power of the imagination!

And I'm sorry that it cannot work out, for I won't allow it, for I am presently occupied with the priority of my success over my happiness. To submit to you would be a surrendering of the stubborn morality by which I am guided, the morality which constitutes myself, inseparably me.